

# TrustMRR: a look inside startup data

## THE SAMPLE

I,000

companies, every revenue figure  
pulled from Stripe by API

## THE HEADLINE

\$334M

lifetime revenue, verified rather  
than self-reported

## THE REALITY

\$400

median monthly revenue across  
the same thousand

# What we think we're looking at

Small teams, an AI tailwind, global reach, \$10k MRR within reach. The dataset appears to confirm all of it.

\$334M

lifetime revenue,  
verified

500,597

active subscriptions

65

countries  
represented

197

AI companies — the  
largest category

Every figure on this slide is true, and pulled from a payment provider.

# It's a lottery, not a ladder

\$400

median monthly revenue

58%

earn under \$1,000 a month

0.906

Gini — worse than any economy



Cumulative share of \$15.6M in verified monthly revenue; 22% of the thousand earn exactly zero.

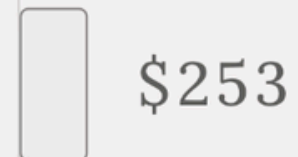
# The blanks tell the real story

130 companies list themselves as “Stealth Company” — no name, no website, no description. They are the highest-earning cohort in the dataset.

THE 130 THAT SAY NOTHING



EVERYONE ELSE



Median monthly revenue, one bar drawn to the other's scale. The founders who fill in every field — the value proposition, the persona, the pricing — are the ones with the least to show.

# Not the idea. The buyer.

| SIGNAL                | WHAT THE DATA SHOWS                            | PREDICTS REVENUE |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Social following      | Correlation of 0.17 with monthly revenue       | No ×             |
| Being in AI           | The most crowded category; median MRR \$446    | No ×             |
| Growth rate           | Correlates with nothing else in the set        | No ×             |
| Selling to businesses | \$49 revenue per customer, against \$9 for B2C | Yes ✓            |

B2C outnumbered B2B 401 to 255 — and earns a fifth as much per customer.

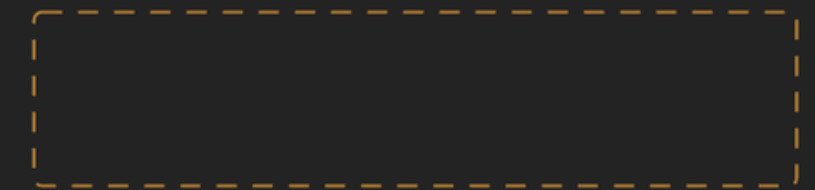
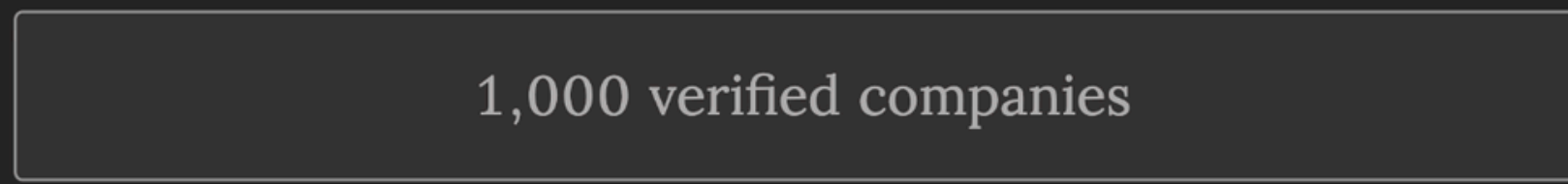
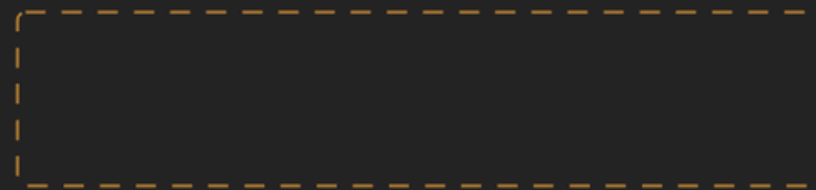


# Verified is not the same as representative

UNDER-COUNTED

WHAT TRUSTMRR SEES

HIDDEN



earning nothing — no reason to list at all

earning well — no reason to publish a name

The bottom is under-counted

A company earning nothing has no reason to list itself.

The floor here is the floor of the willing.

The top is hidden

A company earning well stays quiet: two of the ten largest earners here are unnamed.

Every number is individually true. The population they describe is not the population we care about.

# The market prices the illusion

A quarter of these companies are for sale. The multiple is calculated on last month's revenue, annualised.

1 in 4

of the 1,000 companies is listed  
for sale

\$35,000

median asking price

× 12

what one good month does to  
that price

47 listings ask for money while showing zero revenue.

# Transparency solved the wrong problem

TrustMRR fixed the lying. It did not fix the seeing.

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FOR BUILDERS

Who you sell to and how you price, not the category you pick.

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FOR BUYERS

The headline multiple is run-rate, not revenue. Discount it.

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FOR READERS

Ask who chose to be in the sample before asking what the sample says.

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The numbers were honest. The picture still wasn't.